

Hands-on Lab: Windows Defender Firewall



In this lab, you will learn to:

- Configure the Windows Defender Firewall using the basic user interface.
- Understand the different types of network profiles: Domain, Private, and Public.
- Enable or disable the firewall for each network profile.
- Manage incoming connections to improve the security of your Windows system.

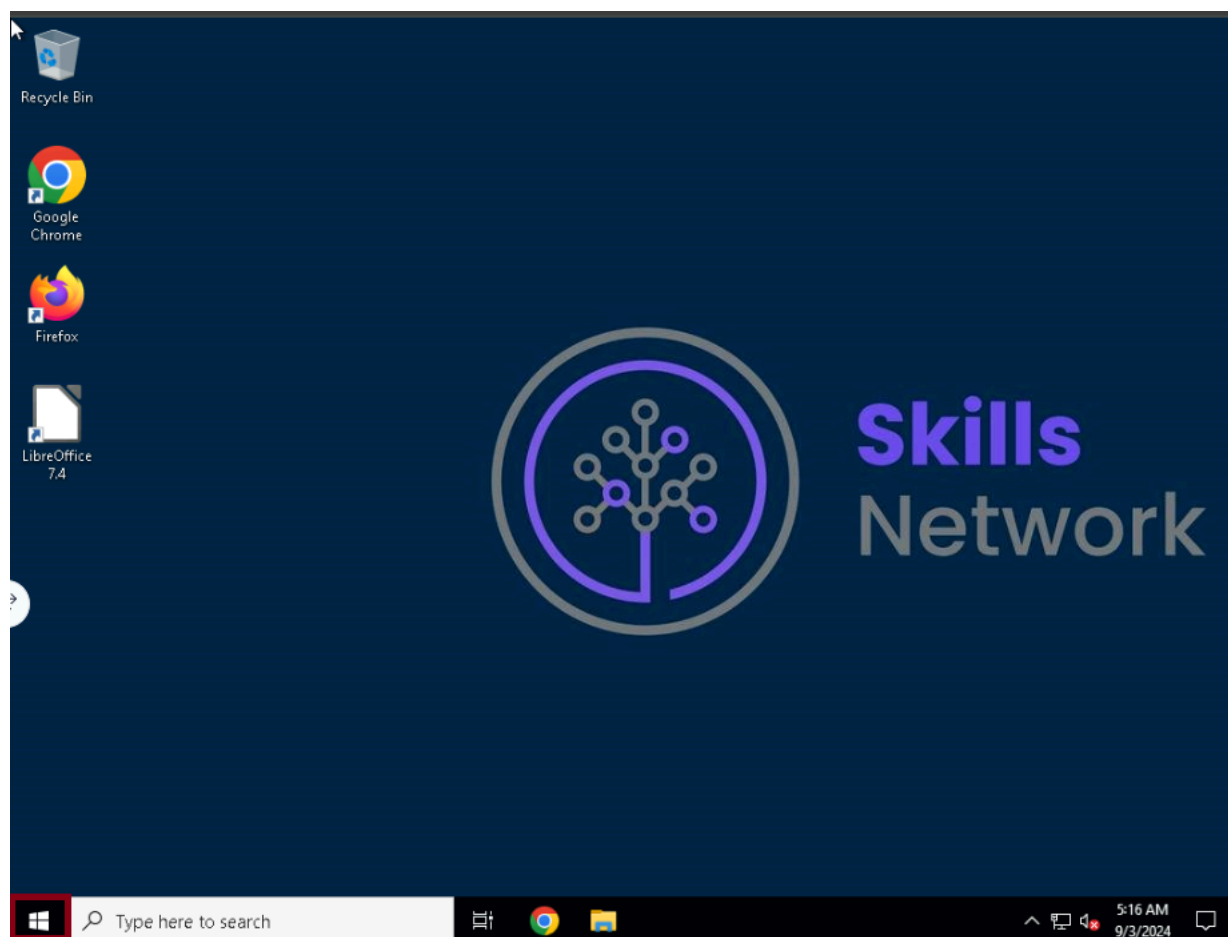
Important Information About Lab Instructions and Solutions

In case you try to use your physical keyboard in the lab environment, it might not produce any visible results. To avoid this issue, please use the On-Screen Keyboard (you can find it by searching for On-Screen Keyboard in the search bar at the bottom of your screen). If search functionality doesn't work, you can also click on the Windows icon, scroll down to find Windows Ease of Access, click on it, and then select On-Screen Keyboard.

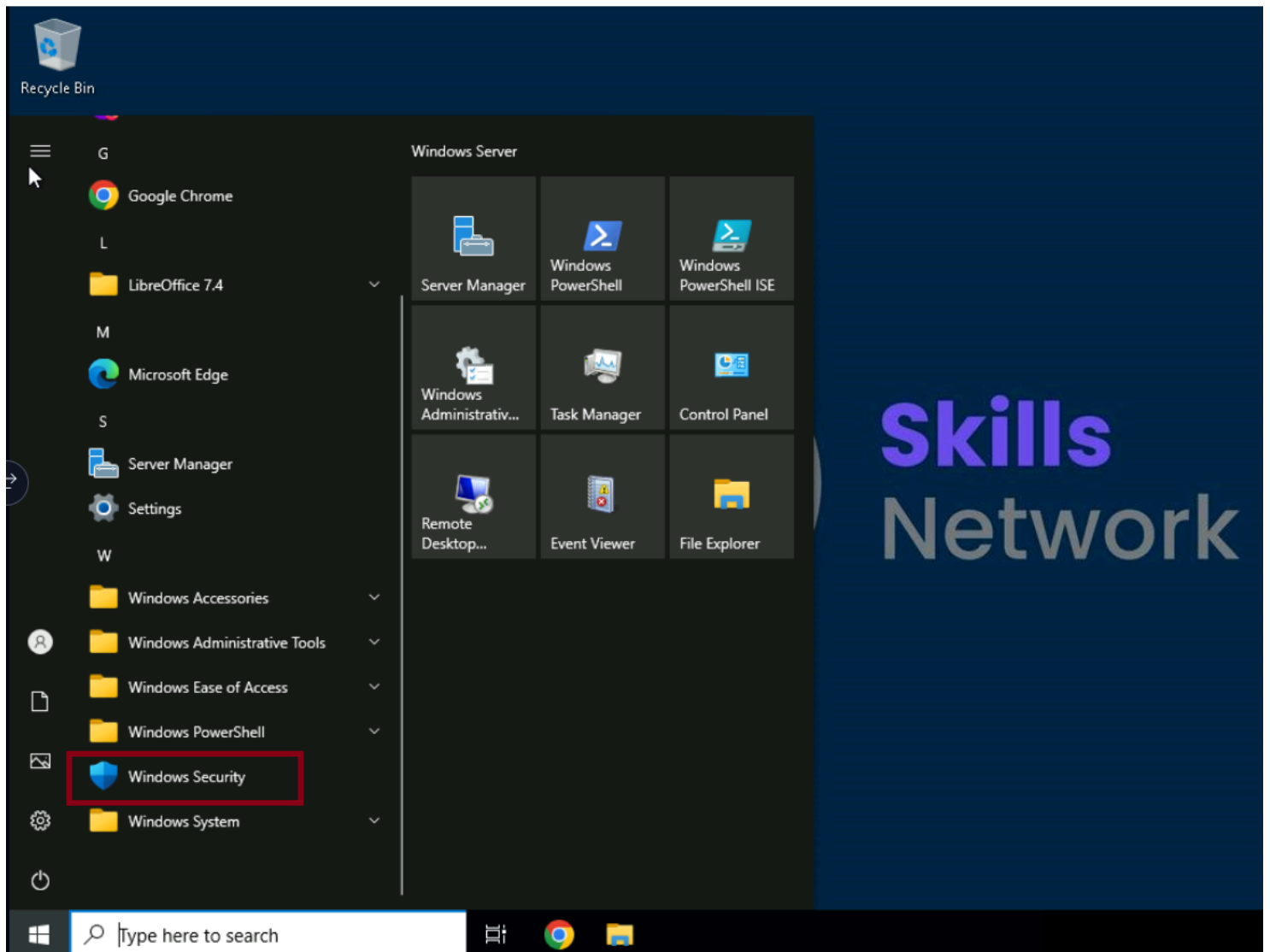
Microsoft Windows operating system features can vary based on the Windows edition. If completing these exercises on your machine, your navigation and solutions may differ from what's presented in this lab.

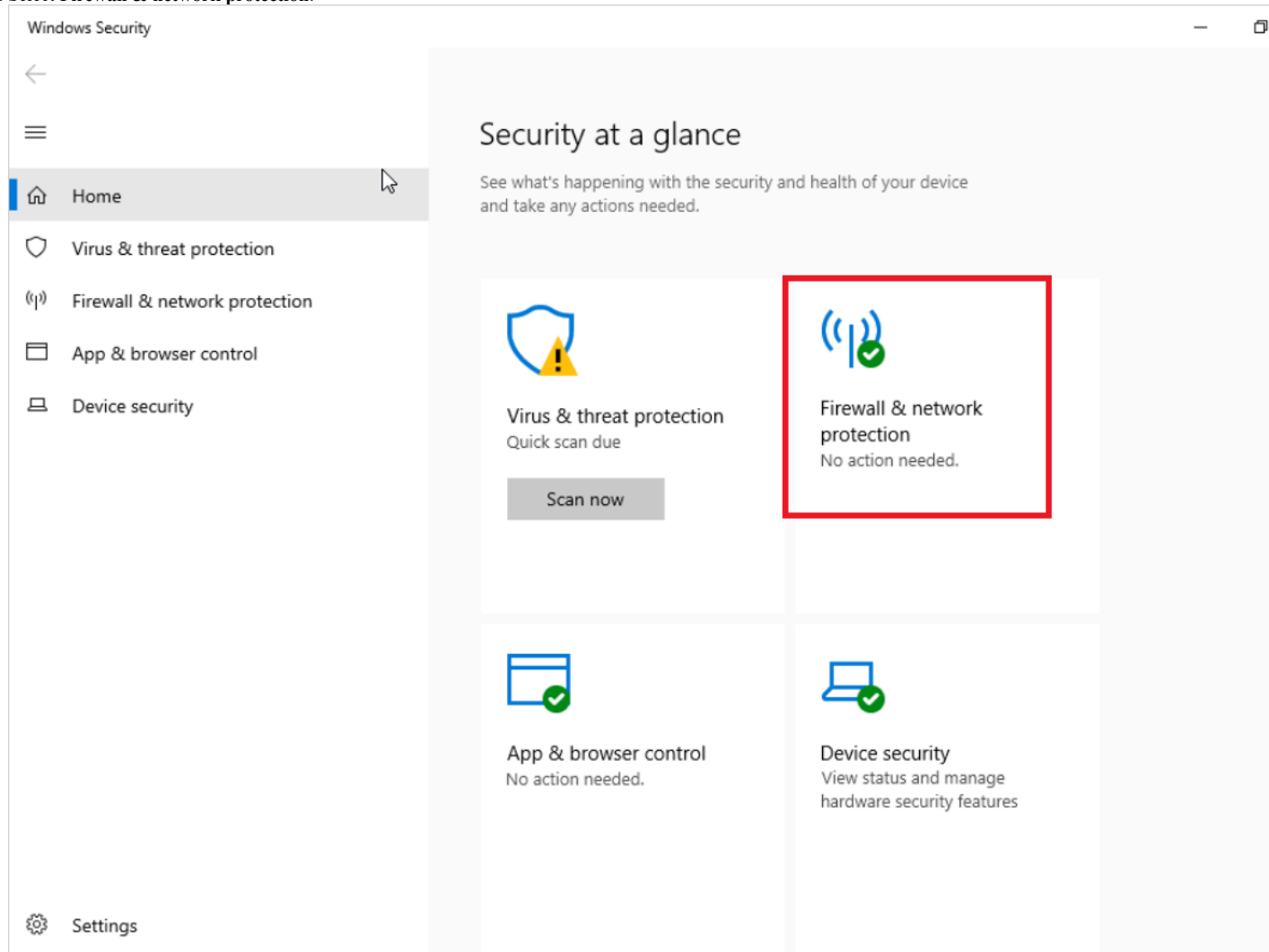
Instructions

1. Select the Windows **Start** button.



2. Scroll down to select **Windows Security**.



3. Select **Firewall & network protection**.

Here you will see the firewall status for the following:

- Domain network: Used for networks where an Active Directory domain controller authenticates accounts.
- Private network: Used for home networks
- Public network: Used for guest networks open to the public (coffee shops, libraries, hotels).

4. Select **Domain network**.

Windows Security

←

☰

🏠 Home

🛡️ Virus & threat protection

🔒 Firewall & network protection

📁 App & browser control

🛡️ Device security

⚙️ Settings

Firewall & network protection

Who and what can access your networks.

🔒

Domain network

Firewall is on.

🔒

Private network

Firewall is on.

🔒

Public network (active)

Firewall is on.

- [Allow an app through firewall](#)
- [Network and Internet troubleshooter](#)
- [Firewall notification settings](#)
- [Advanced settings](#)
- [Restore firewalls to default](#)

Windows Community videos

[Learn more about Firewall & network protection](#)

Who's protecting me?

[Manage providers](#)

Change your privacy settings

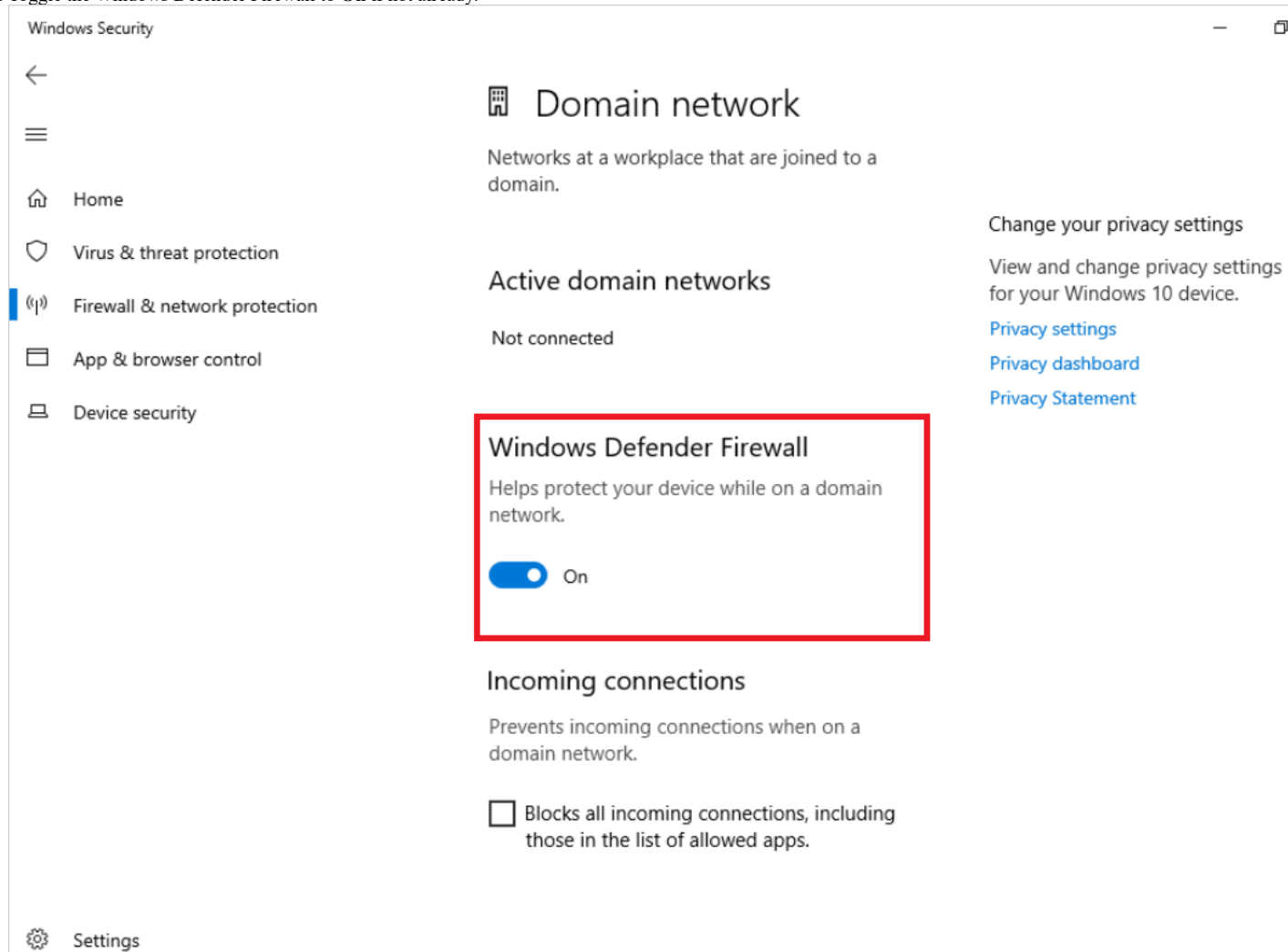
View and change privacy settings for your Windows 10 device.

[Privacy settings](#)

[Privacy dashboard](#)

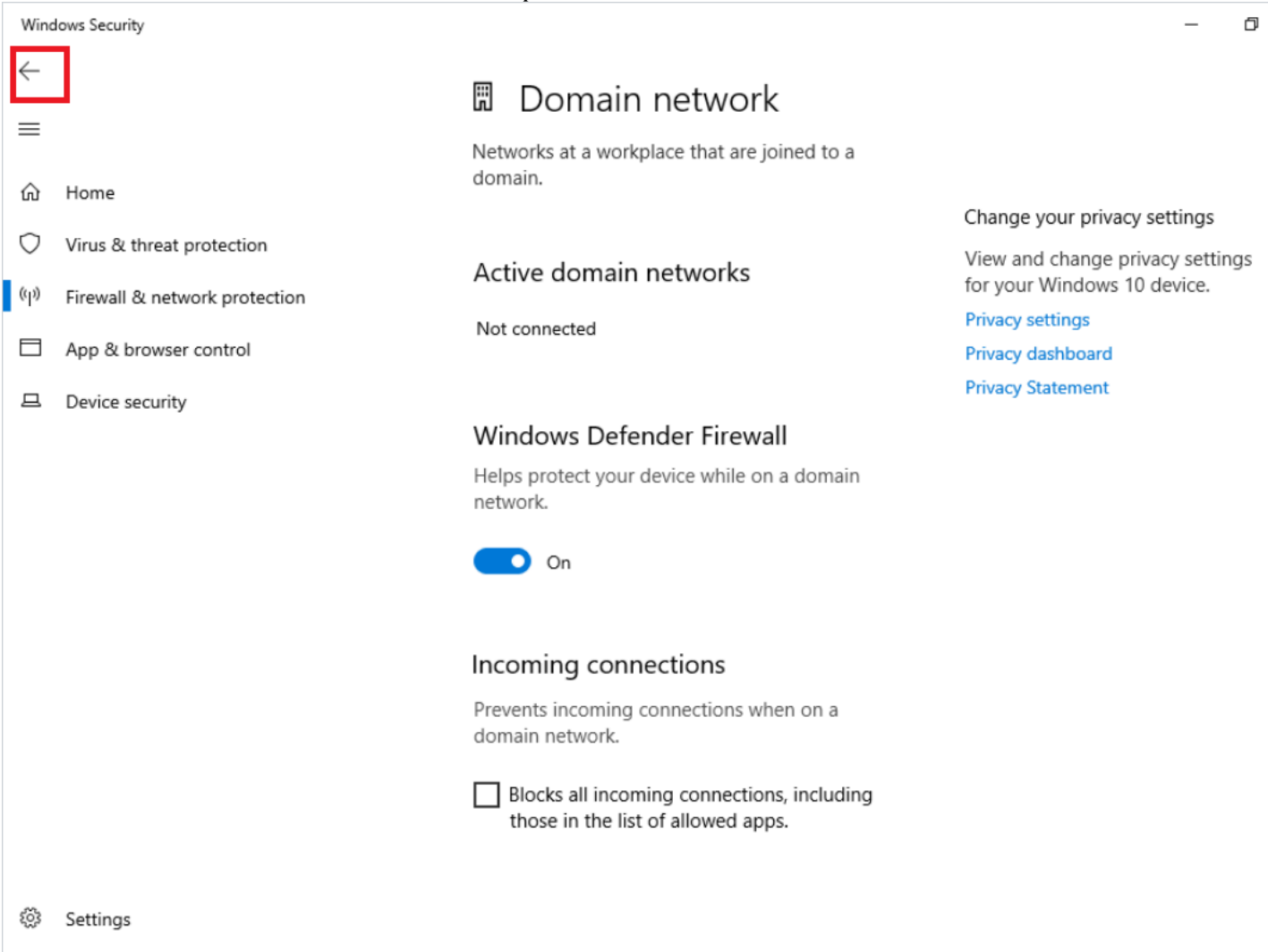
[Privacy Statement](#)

5. Toggle the Windows Defender Firewall to **On** if not already.



Note the checkbox under **Incoming connections**. This checkbox is a quick access location that blocks all incoming domain network traffic on normally permitted traffic.

6. Select the back arrow button to return to the **Firewall and network protection** screen.



7. Select **Private network**.

Windows Security

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☰

🏠 Home

🛡️ Virus & threat protection

🔒 Firewall & network protection

📁 App & browser control

🛡️ Device security

⚙️ Settings

🔒 Firewall & network protection

Who and what can access your networks.

🏠 Domain network

Firewall is on.

🏠 Private network

Firewall is on.

🌐 Public network (active)

Firewall is on.

[Allow an app through firewall](#)

[Network and Internet troubleshooter](#)

[Firewall notification settings](#)

[Advanced settings](#)

[Restore firewalls to default](#)

Windows Community videos

[Learn more about Firewall & network protection](#)

Who's protecting me?

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Change your privacy settings

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[Privacy settings](#)

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[Privacy Statement](#)

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8. Verify that the Windows Defender Firewall is toggled to **On**.

Windows Security

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Home

Virus & threat protection

Firewall & network protection

App & browser control

Device security

Private network

Networks at home or work, where you know and trust the people and devices on the network, and where your device is set as discoverable.

Active private networks

Not connected

Windows Defender Firewall

Helps protect your device while on a private network.

☒ On

Incoming connections

Prevents incoming connections when on a private network.

☐ Blocks all incoming connections, including those in the list of allowed apps.

Change your privacy settings

View and change privacy settings for your Windows 10 device.

[Privacy settings](#)

[Privacy dashboard](#)

[Privacy Statement](#)

Settings

Note the checkbox under **Incoming connections**. This is a quick access location that blocks all incoming private network traffic, even traffic that is normally permitted.

9. Select the back arrow button to return to the **Firewall and network protection** screen.

Windows Security





 Home

 Virus & threat protection

 Firewall & network protection

 App & browser control

 Device security

 Settings

 Private network

Networks at home or work, where you know and trust the people and devices on the network, and where your device is set as discoverable.

Active private networks

Not connected

Windows Defender Firewall

Helps protect your device while on a private network.

 On

Incoming connections

Prevents incoming connections when on a private network.

☐ Blocks all incoming connections, including those in the list of allowed apps.

Change your privacy settings

View and change privacy settings for your Windows 10 device.

[Privacy settings](#)

[Privacy dashboard](#)

[Privacy Statement](#)

10. Select **Public network**.

Windows Security

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☰

Home

Virus & threat protection

Firewall & network protection

App & browser control

Device security

Settings

 Firewall & network protection

Who and what can access your networks.

 Domain network

Firewall is on.

 Private network

Firewall is on.

 Public network (active)

Firewall is on.

Allow an app through firewall

Network and Internet troubleshooter

Firewall notification settings

Advanced settings

Restore firewalls to default

Windows Community videos

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Who's protecting me?

[Manage providers](#)

Change your privacy settings

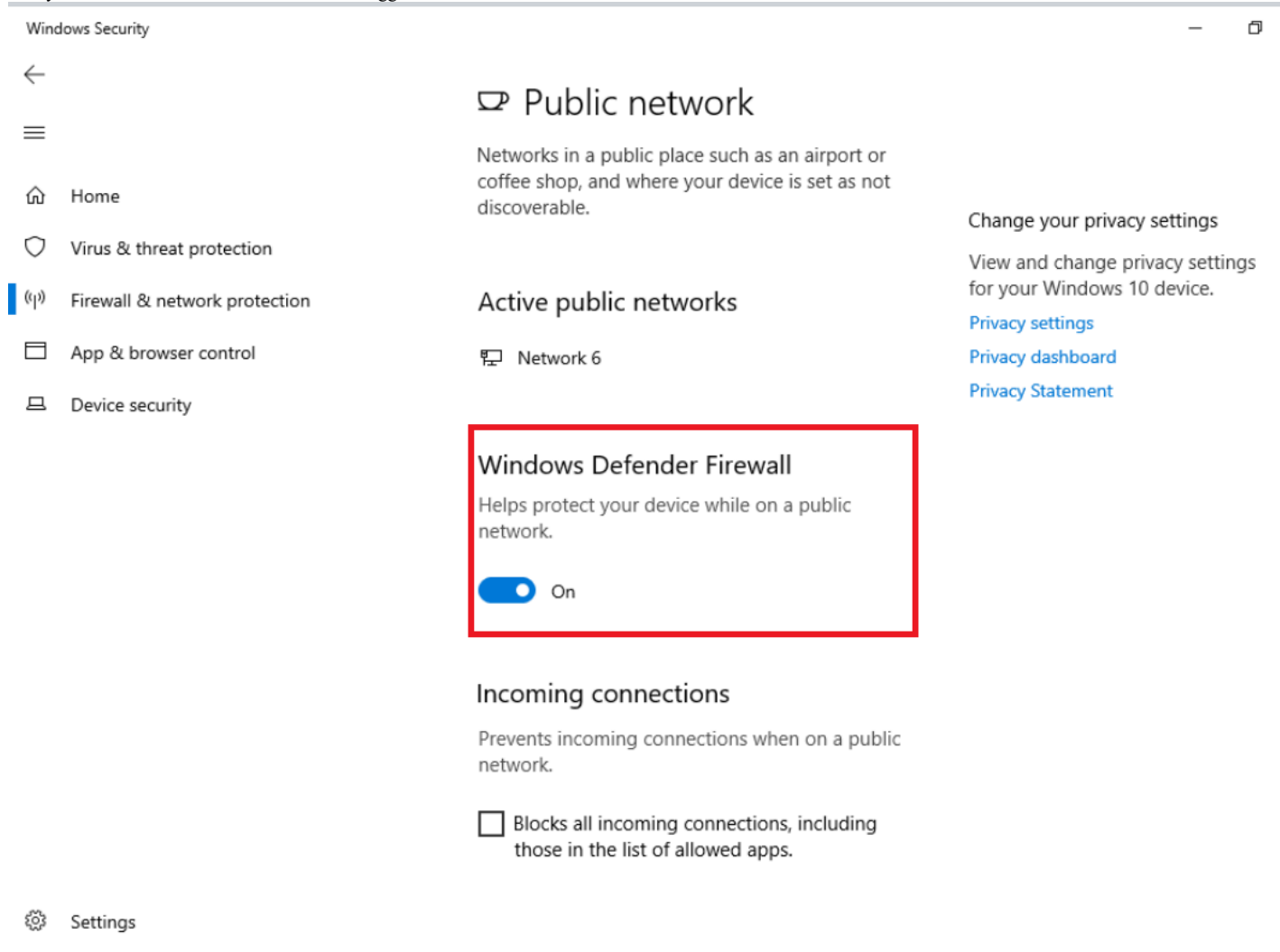
View and change privacy settings for your Windows 10 device.

[Privacy settings](#)

[Privacy dashboard](#)

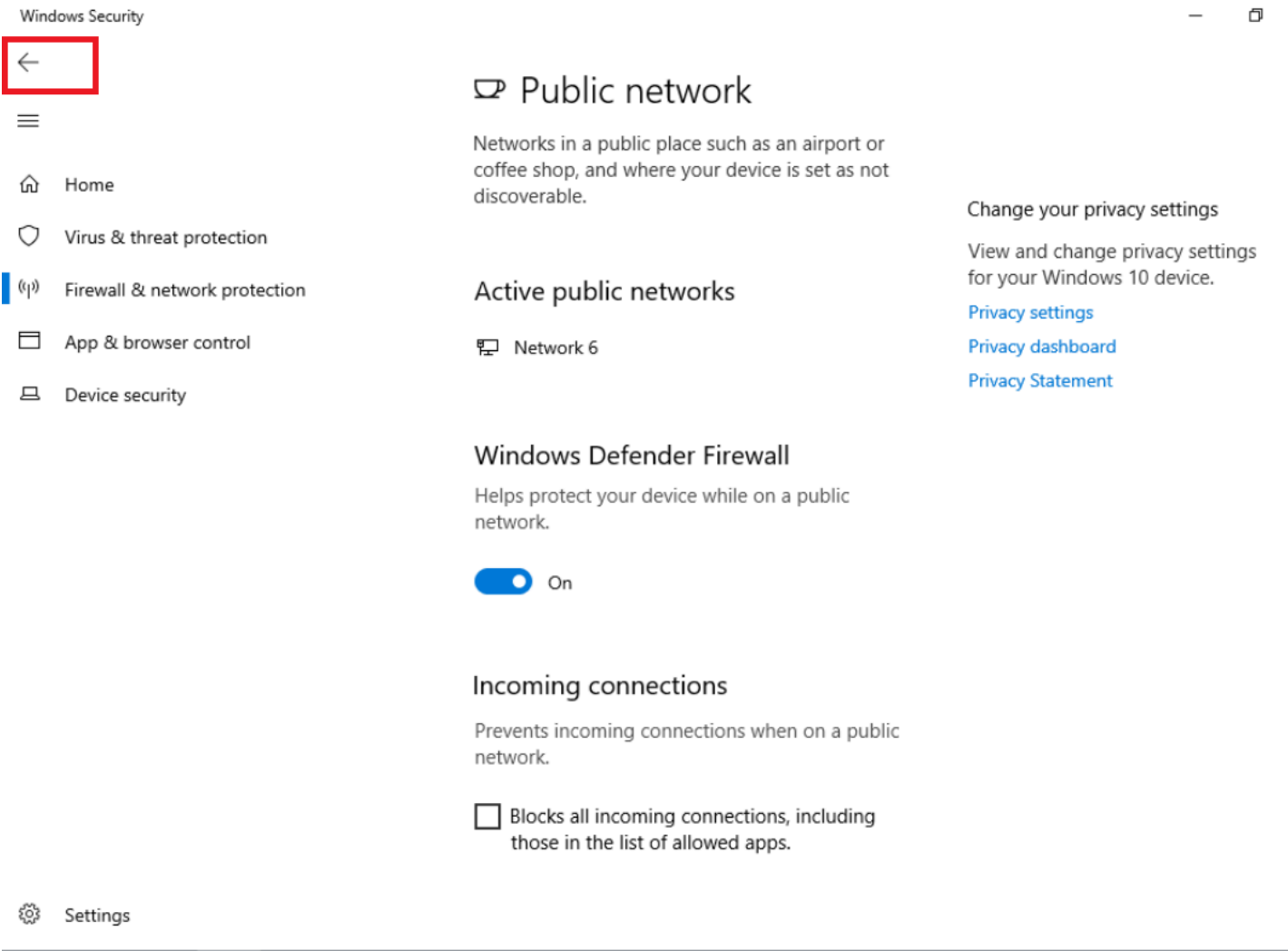
[Privacy Statement](#)

11. Verify that the Windows Defender Firewall is toggled to **On**.



Note the checkbox under **Incoming connections**. This quick access location blocks all incoming public network traffic, even typically permitted traffic.

12. Select the back arrow button to return to the **Firewall and network protection** screen.



Author(s)

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